



Bye bye Internet Explorer

Windows 11 is the first version without IE after more than 20 years.
<https://digit.in/jul21-11>



Mexico bans Crypto

Mexico's Finance Minister, Arturo Herrera, confirms cryptos are banned from financial system. <https://digit.in/jul21-12>

EVERY STEP YOU TAKE...

Fitness apps engaging in data-harvesting habits could spell bad news for your privacy

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itness trackers and apps are a dime a dozen today and they're slowly inching towards

becoming ubiquitous in the Indian market. This is especially true now, with COVID-19 being in the picture, since many of the fitness trackers on the market offer the ability to track vitals such as SpO2 and heart rate. Additionally, the pandemic has also made people more aware of their health and fitness, leading to the heightened pervasion of fitness apps. While these apps and trackers are handy for monitoring one's health and fitness, significant privacy

concerns stem from the data they collect and can potentially share.

DATA COLLECTED BY HEALTH APPS

Health and medical data are usually collected by fitness apps to analyse your health, provide statistics and feedback. However, this is the sort of data that is usually pretty sensitive and users wouldn't want them getting into the wrong hands. Data collected by these apps and trackers include what prescription drugs you take, how much you exercise, your daily walk/run route, or even the kind of birth control you're using.

This sensitive data could be at the disposal of fitness app creators and could be sold to businesses for nefarious purposes. Or the data could be sold to simply get a more comprehensive picture of the user's lifestyle and habits to accurately target ads at them. In case of a hack, users could actually be put in

physical danger since the apps could reveal the user's home addresses and even their real-time location.

In a research conducted by the British Medical Journal, Muhammad Ikram, a lecturer at the Macquarie University Cyber Security Hub divulged that out of over 20,000 health and fitness apps on the Google Play Store, over 88 per cent of fitness apps were found to be utilising "tracking identifiers and cookies to track user activities on mobile devices, and some of these applications are actually using tracking across different platforms".

The researchers also discovered that approximately two-thirds of the

apps studied could collect advertising identifiers or cookies. On the other hand, one-third could collect information such as email addresses, and other inputted details. Some apps are also able to identify the cell tower that the user's device is



A research conducted by the British Medical Journal studied data collection by fitness and health apps